THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE · Nursery – Class XII · Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur · 9887258679

CLASS VIII — ENGLISH · MID-TERM PRACTICE PAPER

Session 2026–27 · Set 04

Class: VIII	Subject: English	Time: 2½ Hours	Max. Marks: 60

General Instructions:

1. The Question Paper is divided into FOUR sections. Section A: Reading 14 marks; Section B: Grammar 14 marks; Section C: Writing 12 marks; Section D: Literature 20 marks.
2. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part.
3. Marks are indicated against each question.
4. Read the questions carefully before answering.

SECTION A — READING (14 Marks) — 14 marks

Q1. Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow: **7**

Chandrayaan-3: India Touches the Moon

On 23 August 2023, India became the first country to land a spacecraft near the Moon's south pole. The lander, named Vikram, touched down gently after a tense final descent of nearly twenty minutes, while scientists at ISRO watched anxiously. Soon after, the rover Pragyan rolled out to study the lunar soil.

The mission cost far less than similar missions of other countries, showing that careful planning and local engineering can achieve great results. Young students across the country celebrated by drawing rockets and writing poems, and many declared that they too wished to become scientists.

1. What was the name of the lander of Chandrayaan-3? **1**

(a) Pragyan (b) Vikram
(c) Aryabhata (d) Mangal

2. What did the rover Pragyan do? **1**

(a) Landed the spacecraft (b) Studied the lunar soil
(c) Photographed Earth (d) Launched the rocket

3. What does the low cost of the mission show? **1**

(a) The mission was careless
(b) Careful planning and local engineering can succeed
(c) Rockets are cheap to build
(d) Other countries did not try

4. The word 'anxiously' in the passage means: **1**

(a) Happily (b) With worry and nervousness
(c) Lazily (d) Proudly

5. How did students across the country celebrate the success? Mention two ways. **2**

6. Why was the final descent of the lander 'tense'? **1**

Q2. Study the poster carefully and answer the questions that follow: **7**



Plastic bags and bottles take hundreds of years to break down. They choke drains, harm animals that mistake them for food and pollute rivers and oceans. Small changes in daily habits, like carrying our own bags and bottles, can reduce the amount of plastic that reaches landfills. Schools are urging students to take a pledge and spread the message at home.

1) What happens to plastic bags in drains? **1**

(a) They dissolve (b) They choke the drains
(c) They help water flow (d) They float away

2) Which poster instruction deals with food and lunch? **1**

(a) Carry a jute bag (b) Use a steel bottle and tiffin
(c) Refuse single-use plastic (d) Segregate waste

3) Why do animals suffer because of plastic? **1**

(a) They like plastic toys (b) They mistake it for food
(c) It keeps them warm (d) It makes them sleepy

4) What is the purpose of the campaign? **1**

(a) To sell plastic goods (b) To reduce plastic use
(c) To cut trees (d) To build roads

5) How can students spread the message at home? Suggest two ways. **2**

6) Name any one harm of plastic mentioned in the passage. **1**

SECTION B — GRAMMAR (14 Marks) — 14 marks

Q3. Do as directed.

I. Attempt any 4 from the following questions by choosing the most appropriate options. **(4x1=4)**

1) The teacher asked us to _____ the poem by heart.

(a) learn (b) learned off
(c) learn off (d) learning

2) He _____ a bad cold last week and missed school.

(a) caught (b) catch
(c) catches (d) catching

3) Please _____ the lights when you leave.

(a) switch off (b) switch after
(c) switch of (d) switch through

4) The students _____ for the picnic when it began to rain.

(a) were leaving (b) leaves

(c) leave (d) have left

5) The old man _____ at the door for ten minutes before it opened.

(a) has stood (b) had been standing

(c) stands (d) will stand

II. Attempt any 4 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. (4x1=4)

6) Choose the correct comparative: Mount Everest is _____ than K2.

(a) high (b) higher

(c) highest (d) most high

7) Choose the superlative: She is the _____ girl in the class.

(a) tall (b) taller

(c) tallest (d) more tall

8) 'Good, better, best' shows degrees of comparison.

(State True or False.)

9) Fill in the blank with the correct degree. This is the _____ (beautiful) place I have ever seen.

10) Choose the correct sentence.

(a) He is more taller than Raj. (b) He is taller than Raj.

(c) He is tallest than Raj. (d) He is tall than Raj.

III. Attempt any 3 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. (3x1=3)

11) Choose the correct past tense: She _____ the exam yesterday.

(a) pass (b) passed

(c) passes (d) passing

12) Fill in with the past tense of 'go'. They _____ to Mumbai last summer.

13) 'Had eaten' is the past perfect tense.

(State True or False.)

14) When I reached the station, the train _____.

(a) left (b) had left

(c) leaves (d) has left

IV. Attempt any 3 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. (3x1=3)

15) Identify the voice: The cake was baked by my mother.

(a) Active (b) Passive

(c) Neither (d) Both

16) Change into passive voice. Ravi wrote the letter. → The letter _____ by Ravi.

17) 'The boy kicked the ball' is in the passive voice.

(State True or False.)

18) Change into active: The window was broken by the boy.

(a) The boy broke the window. (b) The boy breaks the window.

(c) The window broke the boy. (d) The boy had broken the window.

SECTION C — WRITING (12 Marks) 12 marks

Q4. Answer any one from A and B. (1x6=6)

(A) Your school is organising a Science Exhibition on 10 January. Write a notice in about 50 words inviting students to participate and giving the last date for registration. You are the Science Club Secretary.

O R

(B) Complete a short story in 100–120 words that begins: 'The lights went out suddenly and the whole house fell silent…'

Q5. Answer any one from A and B. **(1x6=6)**

(A) Write a letter to your Principal in 100–120 words requesting her to arrange a career-counselling session for the students of Class VIII. You are Neha/Nikhil, the Class Monitor.

O R

(B) You saw an advertisement for a second-hand bicycle. Write a letter to the seller in 100–120 words enquiring about its age, condition, price and the possibility of a test ride.

SECTION D — LITERATURE (20 Marks) — 20 marks

Q6. Read the following passage and answer any four out of the five questions that follow: **(4x1=4)**

> Bibha Chowdhuri, an Indian physicist born in Kolkata in 1913, was among the first women scientists of India. She studied cosmic rays, the invisible particles that reach the earth from space. Working with limited equipment, she made discoveries that earned her international recognition. Though she faced the challenge of being a woman in a male-dominated field, she followed her curiosity and never gave up.

a) Bibha Chowdhuri was a _____ . (physicist / poet) *(physicist / poet)*

b) She studied cosmic rays.
(State True or False.)

c) What challenge did she face?
(a) Lack of interest
(b) Being a woman in a male-dominated field
(c) No school
(d) Wars

d) The passage shows that she was:
(a) lazy (b) curious and determined
(c) shy (d) careless

e) What can we learn from her life?

Q7. Read the following extract and answer any two out of the three questions that follow: **(2x2=4)**

The river runs from hill to sea,
It sings of how it longs to be
A part of something wide and blue,
And I would like to follow too.

a) Where does the river run from and to?

b) What does the river long to be?

c) Which word rhymes with 'blue'?

Q8. Answer any four out of the five questions given below. **(4x3=12)**

a) How does 'Somebody's Mother' teach us kindness? Explain in about 50 words.

b) Why is Major Somnath Sharma remembered as a hero? Give three reasons.

c) What challenges did Verghese Kurien face in his mission? How did he overcome them?

d) In what ways was Tenali Ramakrishna different from the other courtiers?

e) If you could meet any one of the personalities you studied, whom would you meet and why? Write in 40–50 words.